

01 · THE SERIES

THE LONG GAME

WHY CLUB VOLLEYBALL
ISN'T A SEASON



THE ORIENTATION MOST FAMILIES NEVER GET.



THE SERIES

FIVE LESSONS. ONE PLAYER.

01

Why Club Volleyball Isn't a Season

← You are here

02

The Year-to-Year Trap

Coming up.

03

What You're Actually Building

Coming up.

04

Stay the Course or Make the Switch

Coming up.

05

The Season Review Framework

Coming up.

HEAR THIS ONCE

YOU'RE NOT SIGNING UP
FOR PRACTICES.
YOU'RE SIGNING UP
FOR A DECADE.

Most families plan year to year. That's exactly where the burnout, panic, and second-guessing begin.

— THE JOURNEY STARTS WITH THE QUESTION

THE LONG GAME QUESTION

WHAT ARE YOU ACTUALLY BUILDING?

→ Immediate playing time and short-term wins?

→ College exposure and recruiting visibility?

→ A kid who still loves the game in 10 years?

— THE ANSWER CHANGES EVERY DECISION YOU'LL MAKE THIS SEASON.

DRIFT, REACT, REGRET

DRIFT

Families without a framework wander from club to club chasing outcomes they haven't defined.

REACT

Every playing-time change, roster move, or coaching decision becomes a crisis.

REGRET

Years later, they realize they optimized for the wrong thing.



WHAT THE LONG GAME LOOKS LIKE

ZOOM OUT

Treat each season as one chapter, not the whole story.

DEFINE FIRST

Name what you're building before evaluating any decision against it.

STAY VS. SWITCH

Every choice gets measured against the long-game goal, not emotion.

02



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

FAMILIES WHO PLAN
IN SEASONS BURN OUT.
FAMILIES WHO BUILD
TOWARD A VISION GROW.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— CLARITY BEFORE COMMITMENT

THIS WEEK

BEFORE NEXT SEASON, ANSWER THESE.

✓ What does your athlete actually want from this journey, in her own words?

✓ What is your family's real capacity: time, money, emotional bandwidth?

✓ What would a successful 10-year journey look like?

✓ What would you regret not doing differently starting now?



THE LONG GAME

THE YEAR-TO-YEAR TRAP

02

REACTING EVERY SEASON ISN'T A STRATEGY. IT'S A SYMPTOM.



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REACTING EVERY SEASON
ISN'T A STRATEGY.
IT'S A SYMPTOM.

Without a framework, emotion drives every decision, and emotion makes terrible long-game choices.

— EMOTION WITHOUT FRAMEWORK IS CHAOS

THE DRIFT CYCLE

WHERE FAMILIES LOSE THE THREAD.

- Panic when playing time shifts mid-season
- Compare against other families and other clubs
- Make emotional decisions that feel right in the moment but cost long-term

— BREAKING THE CYCLE REQUIRES A DECISION MADE BEFORE THE EMOTION ARRIVES.

05 · WHAT TRIGGERS THE TRAP

THE THREE ALARM BELLS

PLAYING TIME

Her role changes and the entire season narrative collapses.

CLUB COMPARISON

A teammate switches clubs and suddenly every decision is in question.

COACH FRICTION

One hard conversation becomes evidence that everything is wrong.



06 · BREAKING IT

THE PRE-DECIDED FRAMEWORK

WRITE IT DOWN

Your long-game goal on paper becomes a stabilizer when emotion spikes.

02

THE 48-HOUR RULE

No major decisions within 48 hours of a triggering event.

THE RIGHT QUESTION

Ask 'does this serve the long-game goal?' before any action.



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

THE DECISION YOU MAKE
CALMLY IS THE ONE
YOU'LL BE PROUD OF LATER.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE 48-HOUR RULE



THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, IDENTIFY YOUR PATTERNS.

- ✓ Name three times this season you reacted instead of responded.
- ✓ What triggered each reaction?
- ✓ What decision would you make differently with 48 hours of distance?
- ✓ Write the one criterion you'll use to evaluate every major decision this year.



THE LONG GAME

WHAT YOU'RE
ACTUALLY BUILDING

03

THE GOAL QUESTION CHANGES EVERYTHING.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

THE RIGHT GOAL
CHANGES EVERY DECISION
YOU'LL MAKE THIS SEASON.

There is no wrong answer. But there is a cost to not knowing what you're optimizing for.

— THE GOAL BELONGS TO THE ATHLETE

SIX GOALS PARENTS BRING

WHICH ONE IS YOURS?

→ Playing time · Ranking · Exposure (short-term)

→ College opportunity · Scholarship (medium-term)

→ Development · Confidence · Still loves the game (long-term)

— EACH GOAL IS VALID. EACH HAS A DIFFERENT COST. ONLY ONE CAN LEAD.

ASKING THE RIGHT WAY

WHOSE GOAL?

If the goal belongs to the parent, the athlete quits the moment it gets hard.

THE QUESTION

Ask: what do you want to be able to say about this journey in 10 years?

WRITE IT TOGETHER

Goals written down become anchors. Goals just spoken drift.



06 · ALIGNING THE FAMILY

ONE GOAL, THREE PEOPLE

ATHLETE'S GOAL

Short-term and long-term: her words, her ownership.

FAMILY'S ROLE

Create the conditions. Don't own the outcome.

COACH'S JOB

Train the athlete in front of them. Not the one you hope they become.

02



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

THE ONLY GOALS THAT
SURVIVE PRESSURE ARE
THE ONES THE ATHLETE OWNS.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— OWNERSHIP OVER OBEDIENCE

THIS WEEK

HAVE THE GOAL CONVERSATION THIS WEEK.

- ✓ Sit down with your athlete: no phones, no pressure.
- ✓ Ask: what do you actually want from this? Write her answer down exactly.
- ✓ Define your family's non-negotiables for this season.
- ✓ Name the one thing worth protecting no matter what the scoreboard says.



THE LONG GAME

STAY THE COURSE
OR MAKE THE SWITCH



NEITHER LOYALTY NOR LEAVING IS ALWAYS RIGHT.



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STAYING ISN'T LOYALTY.
LEAVING ISN'T GIVING UP.
BOTH CAN BE WRONG.

The question isn't 'should we leave?' The question is 'what is this situation actually costing us?'

— ONLY THE LONG GAME KNOWS THE ANSWER

STAY VS. SWITCH FRAMEWORK

GROWTH-HARD VS. WRONG-FIT-HARD.

- Growth-hard: uncomfortable, difficult, building something real
- Wrong-fit-hard: misaligned environment, wrong goals, costs without returns
- The test: is this making her better or just making it worse?

— IF YOU CAN'T TELL THE DIFFERENCE, WAIT BEFORE YOU MOVE.

05 · SIGNS YOU SHOULD STAY

WHAT GROWTH LOOKS LIKE

SHE'S BEING CHALLENGED

Hard is not the same as wrong. Difficulty builds the athlete.

THE COACH SEES HER

Even when roles are hard, there is genuine investment in her development.

THE GOAL IS STILL INTACT

The situation is uncomfortable but still aligned with the long-game objective.



06 · SIGNS IT'S TIME TO SWITCH

WHAT MISALIGNMENT LOOKS LIKE

THE ENVIRONMENT CONTRADICTS THE GOAL

Competitive goal, recreational environment, or vice versa.

NO PATH FORWARD

After a full honest season, there is no visible growth trajectory.

SHE'S SURVIVING, NOT GROWING

Enduring is not the same as developing.

02

07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

MAKE YOUR CRITERIA NOW
SO THE DECISION LATER
BELONGS TO LOGIC,
NOT THE MOMENT.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— DECIDE BEFORE THE EMOTION

THIS WEEK

BUILD YOUR DECISION FRAMEWORK TODAY.

✓ Write down three criteria that would make staying the right call.

✓ Write down three criteria that would make switching the right call.

✓ Rate your current situation honestly against both lists.

✓ Give yourself a 30-day window before acting on any answer.



THE LONG GAME

THE SEASON
REVIEW FRAMEWORK

OS

PROGRESS ISN'T VISIBLE IN REAL TIME. IT SHOWS UP WHEN YOU LOOK BACK.



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HEAR THIS ONCE

THE FAMILIES WHO
IMPROVE FASTEST
ARE THE ONES WHO
DEBRIEF WITH INTENTION.

At the end of every season, most families just start the next one. That's how the same patterns repeat for years.

— REVIEW IS PART OF THE TRAINING

THE END-OF-SEASON REVIEW

THREE QUESTIONS. EVERY SEASON.

- What worked, and why did it work?
- What didn't, and what was actually causing it?
- What do we carry forward and what do we leave behind?

— ATHLETES WHO REVIEW THEIR SEASONS OUTPACE THOSE WHO JUST SURVIVE THEM.



FOUR AREAS TO ASSESS

SKILL DEVELOPMENT

Did she measurably improve in the areas that matter for her long-game goal?

MENTAL GAME

How did she perform under pressure compared to the start of the season?

FAMILY SYSTEM

Did the family operate as a team or as a source of stress?



06 · CARRYING IT FORWARD

SETTING NEXT SEASON'S INTENTION

ONE WIN TO PROTECT

Name the most important thing that worked and commit to keeping it.

ONE CHANGE TO MAKE

Identify the one adjustment with the highest return.

THE LONG-GAME CHECK-IN

Is the goal still right, or has the journey revealed something new?



SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

PROGRESS ISN'T VISIBLE
IN REAL TIME.
IT SHOWS UP
WHEN YOU LOOK BACK.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— REVIEW IS TRAINING



THIS WEEK

COMPLETE YOUR SEASON REVIEW THIS WEEK.

- ✓ Name three genuine wins from this season: skill, mindset, or family.
- ✓ Name the one thing you'd change if you could rewind six months.
- ✓ Update your long-game goal based on what this season revealed.
- ✓ Set one intention for next season before the next tryout conversation begins.

